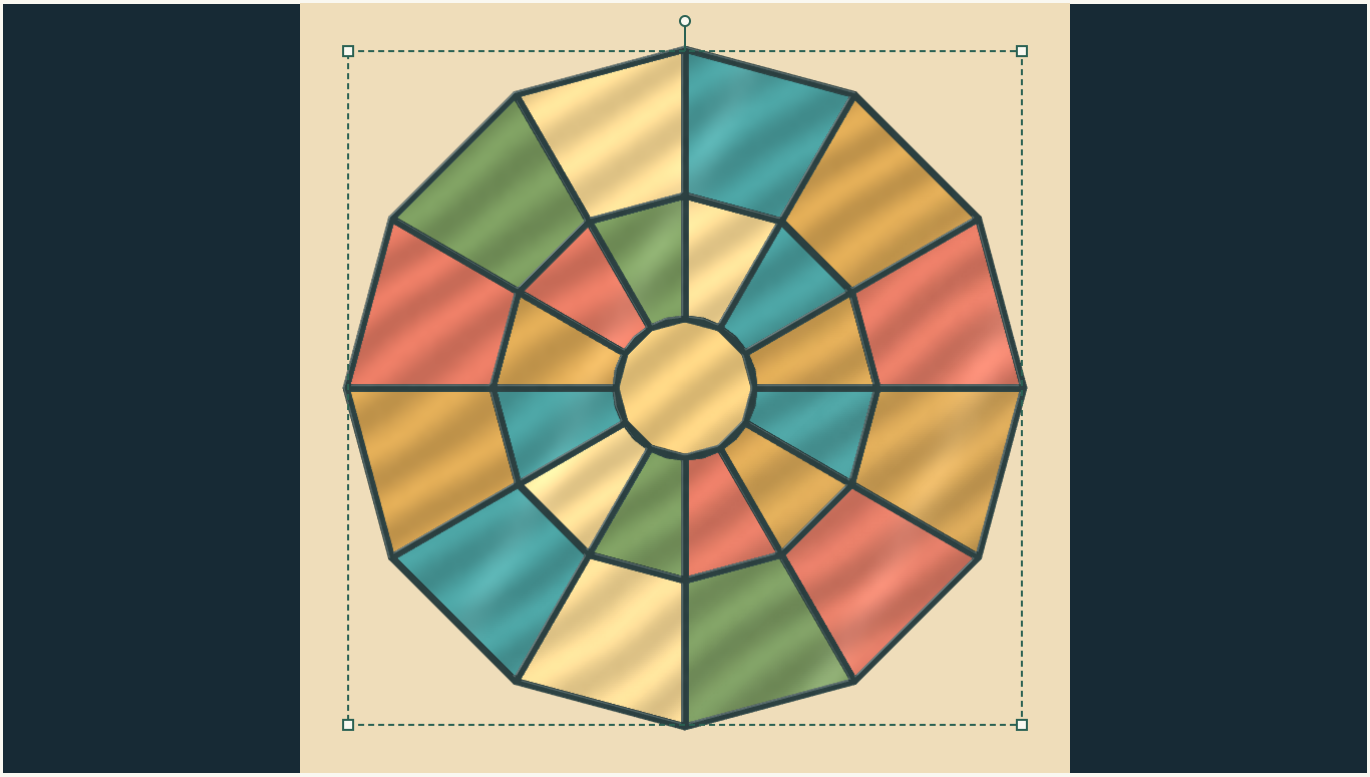
Jago Material

Make artwork from surfaces.

Some artwork wants to feel like something. Cut it from timber, build it from glass panes, wear it down or give it a little broken gold leaf. Jago Material is a craft bench for pictures made from surfaces.

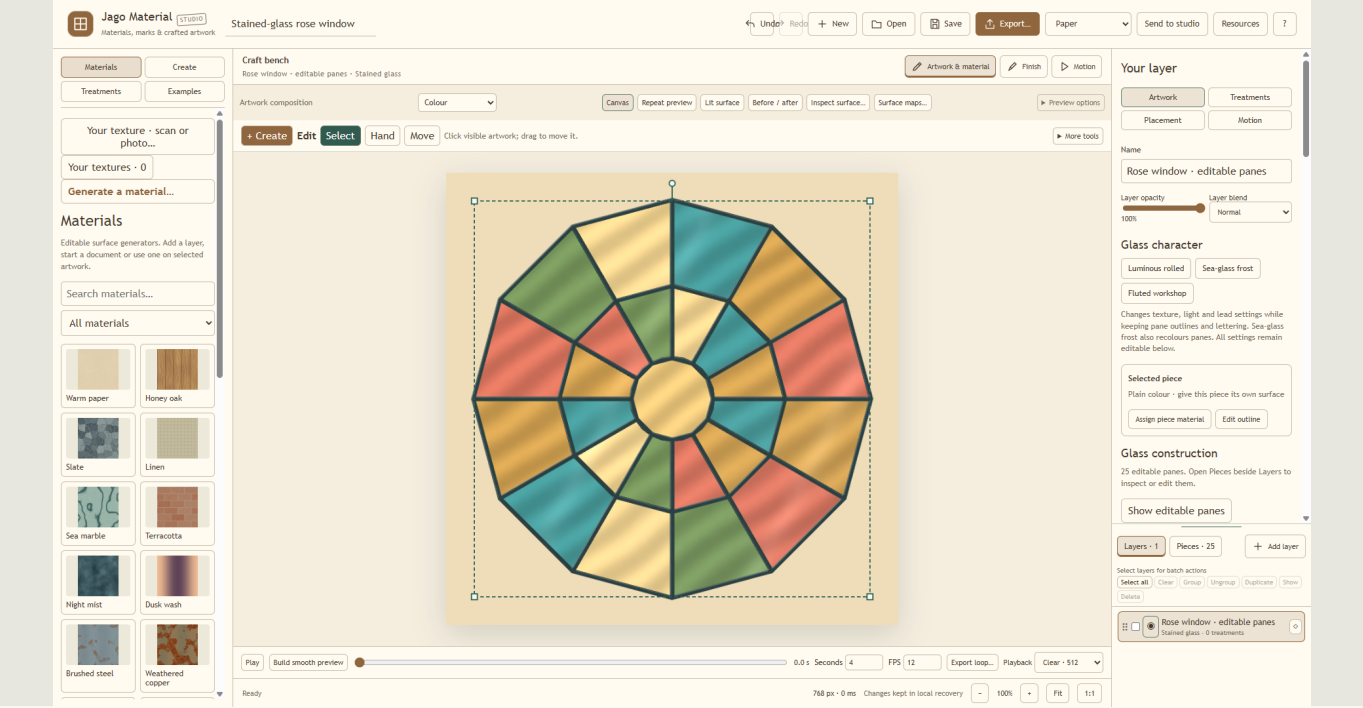


A good place to begin

Make wood, glass, metal and textured artwork, with editable shapes, lettering, finishes and surface maps.

Inside this guide
Start with a small project. Explore the toolbox. Choose the right export. Take the result into another studio.

Start small. Make it yours.



1. Start from your own idea

Choose New and a blank document. Create a shape, closed pen path or text, or import an image.

2. Build the surface

Choose a material for the selected artwork. Use Layers for the composition and Pieces for the parts inside a constructed material.

3. Finish locally

Stack treatments and tune their coverage, opacity and blend. Paint a burn, stain or wear where it belongs rather than covering every part equally.

4. Export what the next tool needs

Export transparent artwork, a repeatable texture, a surface-map kit or timed loop frames. Keep the editable project alongside the result.

Your toolbox

Build the artwork

Create from a blank document, a shape, a path, text, an image or an editable craft study.

Work with separate layers, construction pieces and source artwork.

Material lettering keeps the words, font and surface recipe editable.

Glass lettering builds pane construction and lead outlines; a simple glass fill is a different workflow.

Explore wood, glass, metal and other patterned or textured surfaces with editable colour, style and recipe settings.

Work a finish into it

Stack treatments and control their amounts and coverage.

Preview a finish before applying it to a whole layer, a construction piece or an area you paint.

Finish recipes include waxed and scorched timber, broken gold leaf, copper patina, worn iron, handled metal, rippled glass, absorbed colour and glaze.

Fine wood fibres, metal pores/oxide and glass ripple/seeds contribute to colour and surface channels.

Compare the source, treated artwork and estimated height, roughness and metallic response.

Your own texture belongs here

Import a PNG, JPEG or WebP scan/photo as a surface layer, or use it inside selected artwork.

Control repetition, proportions, rotation and offsets independently of the artwork's placement.

Set roughness and metallic response; opt into brightness relief or supply your own height, roughness and metallic maps.

Save a prepared surface to Your textures or export a portable .jagotexture file.

Use Repeat preview and tile inspection to check seams, or take the tile into Repeat for further work.

Explore and export

Surprise me explores material families, palettes and styles with editable seeded candidates and destination choices.

Use motion and distortion tools for moving surface artwork, then export through the available visual exporters.

Pan with middle mouse or Space, zoom around the pointer and reset with Fit.

Send a colour tile to World as a repeating map surface.

Export technical surface maps for another creative tool, keeping their channel roles explicit.

Take it further.

Save the editable source

Your native project keeps the studio-specific editing information. Save it before making finished exports or passing a rendered result to another tool.

Export options

Editable .jagomaterial projects and material presets
Portable .jagotexture prepared surfaces
PNG colour artwork, transparent selected layers and repeat sheets
PNG frame-sequence loop ZIPs with timing metadata and the editable project
Surface-map ZIP: colour, height, roughness, metallic, normal, ORM and opacity PNGs
OpenGL or DirectX normal choices
Tile proofs and repaired copies
Editable original project included in surface packs

World

Use a rendered repeatable material as a map texture.

Repeat

Inspect and arrange the material as a seamless repeat tile.

Wobble

Bring in animation or send a timed rendered sequence onward.

Library

Place surface artwork into a layout or keep texture kits organised.

Useful things to know.

Surface maps are artist-authored estimates, not physically measured scans.

Lighting is a preview, not a full physically based renderer or realistic glass refraction.

A photograph's dark areas are not automatically dents; brightness relief is optional.

ORM uses neutral occlusion, not measured ambient occlusion.

Surface-map export captures time zero. Repairing one preview channel does not repair every channel automatically.

Open it again

Download the ZIP and choose Extract All. Open Jago-Material.exe from the extracted folder. For offline browser use, open Jago-Material.html. Workscape is a Windows companion. Keep native support folders with their Windows app.

Personal, professional and commercial use are welcome. The apps are open source and free forever. Check the rights of any fonts, images, scores or other assets you import.



Another direction to explore with Jago Material.